

Purdue University

Student Organization Grant Allocation (SOGA)

Guidelines and Restrictions

Updated Summer 2025

Table of Contents

I.	INTRODUCTION.....	2
II.	PURPOSE STATEMENT.....	2
III.	DEFINITIONS	2
IV.	APPLICANT ELIGIBILITY.....	2
V.	POLICY COMPLIANCE	3
VI.	GENERAL GUIDELINES AND RESTRICTIONS (<i>applies to all requests</i>)	3
A.	General Guidelines	3
B.	General Restrictions	4
C.	General Prioritization (Scale 1= most frequently funded, 4= least frequently funded)	5
VII.	APPLYING FOR SOGA FUNDS.....	6
VIII.	SPECIFIC GUIDELINES AND RESTRICTION BY EXPENDITURE TYPE	7
A.	Honoraria and Payment for Professional Services Expenditures	7
B.	Communications Expenditures	7
C.	Equipment Expenditures	8
D.	Travel Expenditures	8
IX.	ALLOCATION PROCESS	9
X.	REQUEST FOR MODIFICATION.....	9
XI.	PROCESSING EXPENDITURES FOR APPROVED EVENTS.....	10
XII.	CONTACT INFORMATION	11

I. INTRODUCTION

Please read the Guidelines and Restrictions carefully before applying for SOGA funding. A student organization must get approval of funding before spending allocated funds and before submitting an expenditure request. It is the responsibility of the organization to reach out to Student Activities and Organizations or the SOGA board with questions, concerns, or seeking clarification regarding the process, as well as be in communication with SOGA regarding any changes to an application, including the organization's point of contact for the application.

II. PURPOSE STATEMENT

The SOGA Board has as its primary purpose the responsible allocation of funds to undergraduate and professional student organizations serving students on the West Lafayette and/or Indianapolis locations registered with the Student Activities & Organizations area of the Vice President of Student Life to support their activities, events, travel, and services. Such activities and events should enhance campus life, allow opportunities for leadership development, promote engagement with the community, and create a forum for the exchange of information and ideas. These funds are made available annually by the Purdue Administration and the Student Activity Fee and therefore must primarily benefit the members of undergraduate and professional student organizations on the West Lafayette and/or Indianapolis locations and support the mission and strategic plan of Purdue University.

III. DEFINITIONS

- SOGA – Student Organization Grant Allocation
- RSO – Recognized student organization serving students on the West Lafayette and/or Indianapolis locations registered with the Student Activities & Organizations area of the Office of the Dean of Students
- APF – Activity Planning Form
- SAO – Student Activities & Organizations area of the Office of the Dean of Students
- BOSO – Business Office for Student Organizations
- ODOS – Office of the Dean of Students
- VPSL – Vice Provost for Student Life
- GSOGA – Graduate Student Organization Grant Allocation

IV. APPLICANT ELIGIBILITY

- Only active RSOs may apply for and receive SOGA funds.
- All student organizations seeking SOGA funds must register annually with SAO. Any student organization that is not registered will not be considered for SOGA funding.
- All SOGA funds must be distributed through RSO accounts in BOSO.
- RSOs that receive an allocation from the University General Fund are not eligible for SOGA funding.
- RSO must be in good standing with SAO, VPSL and BOSO in order to be eligible for funding.
- If RSO has received SFAB funding for the current SOGA application funding period, they are **NOT** eligible for SOGA funding.

V. POLICY COMPLIANCE

It is the responsibility of all RSOs to read and understand all the policies and procedures of Purdue University, the SOGA Board, SAO, and BOSO. RSOs that receive SOGA funding must be in compliance with all policies and procedures at all times. RSOs that are found to be in violation of any policy of Purdue University, the SOGA Board, SAO, or BOSO must reimburse any and all funds they received during the time they were in violation of these policies. Furthermore, any RSO that attempts to defraud or mislead Purdue University, the SOGA Board, SAO, or BOSO will be subject to disciplinary review by VPSL, and those involved may be held individually responsible and criminally liable for any funds received under false pretenses or illegally.

VI. GENERAL GUIDELINES AND RESTRICTIONS (*APPLIES TO ALL REQUESTS*)

A. General Guidelines

1. Programs, services, and activities should be directed primarily to the Purdue undergraduate student community.
2. All Programs, services, and activities must occur within a single one-to-ten-day timeframe within the calendar dates established for each funding period. See the Application and Allocation Schedule (available online and in the SAO Office). Request for funding outside the funding period will not be considered.
 - a. SOGA funded events must occur within a 10-day timeframe (i.e. Dates of workshops and events cannot span across more than 10 consecutive days.
 Example:
 - (a) January 1 to January 10 is 10 days.
 - (b) January 1 to January 11 is 11 days.
 - b. If your event spans two funding periods, apply for funding in the period that includes the first day of the event.
3. Funds may only be used as approved by University Policies in the funding period awarded and as set forth by SAO.
4. An Activity Planning Form must be submitted in Boilerlink at least two weeks prior to the event/activity. Events that require contracting may require an APF submission more than two weeks out.
5. For more information on event contracting timelines, please contact BOSO@purdue.edu
6. The Activity Planning Form must be approved by all appropriate campus partners (i.e. Transportation, BOSO, Space Management, etc.) *prior to the event*.
7. SOGA funds may not be donated to charity. RSOs must follow the University Charity Policy in regard to events or activities. Funding may be used to help with event expenses, but SOGA funds may not be donated to an outside nonprofit agency.
8. Revenue generated at the event may be used to pay expenses not covered by SOGA that are directly related to the approved event. All funds generated from the event must be deposited into the RSO's SOGA account. If an RSO earns net income (profit) at an event above and beyond the award total allocated by SOGA, these funds will be returned to SOGA. BOSO records and Final Reports will be used to track these transactions. Incidental donations will not be included as event-generated revenue. Such donations' mechanisms (if any) must be limited, unobtrusive, and secondary to the events' purpose. These donations must be freely given, with no material benefit provided to the donor.

9. All unused SOGA funds will be remitted back to the SOGA board after each award period and cannot be spent by the RSO
10. If an RSO is awarded SOGA funding for a particular event, those funds will be returned to SOGA if:
 - a. The event is canceled
 - b. The funds are unspent at the end of each award period
 - c. SOGA Guidelines were not followed.
 - d. Activity Planning Form was not submitted 2 weeks before the event. A late or retroactive APF cannot be used for SOGA-funded events.
 - e. Any revenue is made from selling equipment and/or supplies. Selling equipment and/or supplies must go through the appropriate university channels (contact BOSO for the process).
11. Preference will be given to RSOs whose efforts are generally directed toward undergraduate or professional students. RSOs whose events are directed toward graduate students will be referred to the Graduate Student Organization Grant Allocation Board (GSOGA) and may not receive SOGA funding.
12. SOGA Board members may attend any event funded by the SOGA Board. Board members should not place undue burden on the RSO or interfering with the planned experience. Proof of SOGA Board membership can be shown to the RSO using a SFAB nametag or by showing their membership on Boilerlink.
 - a. SOGA Board members may observe any event but cannot act as a participant unless: there is sufficient capacity, and their participation does not displace another attendee or result in additional cost to the RSO
 - b. Board members are responsible for their own transportation to any off-campus event unless prior arrangements are approved by the RSO

B. General Restrictions

1. No RSO shall receive more than \$14,999.99 in a funding year. The \$14,999.99 can be applied for in one funding period or in funding applications spread across all funding periods. All awarded funds will contribute to the \$14,999.99, regardless of if the awarded funds are spent partially or in full. Requests exceeding a cumulative awarded sum of \$14,999.99 will not be considered and the application will automatically be denied.
2. SOGA does not generally fund food. SOGA only funds food in situations where the event's **main focus is an educational component** directly connected to food. The educational component must be **explicitly stated in the application**.
 - a. In general, SOGA will not fund pizza parties, ice cream socials, pancake breakfasts, or similar, unless the educational component is **explicitly stated in the application**. Food cannot be used as a promotional or enticing entity to draw students to an event.
 - b. SOGA does not fund ice or water for consumption.
 - c. SOGA defines the food/beverage line-item categorization to be any consumable substance, or substance that can be processed or synthesized into a consumable substance, for the purpose of the event. Examples include but are not limited to: (1) raw wheat, (2) tea bags, (3) coffee beans.
3. **SOGA WILL NOT FUND THE FOLLOWING:**
 - a. Projects, activities, travel, or services found in violation of law and/or Purdue University rules, regulations, policies, and procedures.
 - b. Items or expenses not included or misclassified in the original SOGA application.

- c. Programs and services that:
 - 1. Are purely social events exclusively for an RSO's members.
 - 2. Are intended to be fundraising projects for the RSO.
 - 3. Are electioneering or lobbying efforts, activities, fund drives or campaigns.
 - 4. Are callouts, rush, recruitment, or initiation meetings or events
- d. Line items that are not clearly explained or not related to the overall application.
- e. Grant applications that list event start dates outside the funding period.
- f. Grant applications that do not contain an adequate description of the request.
- g. Purchase of beer, wine or other alcoholic beverages or any activity or communication, which incorporates a reference to alcoholic beverages or promotes or is supported by an alcoholic beverage manufacturer, distributor, retail operation, sales organization, or vendor.
- h. Purchase of single-use costumes (SOGA will fund rental of these items)
- i. Uniforms or merchandise meant to identify members of the RSO or event staff (e.g. polos, nametags, t-shirts, sweatshirts, etc.)
- j. SOGA will fund costumes or uniforms that are custom designed for a group or team (e.g. "Purdue Team #10") but will not fund costumes or uniforms designed for an individual (e.g. "Purdue Team #10 Nickname/Lastname/etc"). Costumes and uniforms must be retained by the organization and not an individual.
- k. Purchase of equipment when rental is possible, unless the request is in the Equipment general prioritization category.
- l. Plaques, prizes, scholarships, sponsorships, awards, trophies, medals, or other related award or gift items.
- m. Payments to invest in or provide capital for any business or commercial enterprise, or any activity intended to generate a profit.
- n. Expenses and equipment related to telephone, internet, cable, or communication device charges.
- o. Prohibited purchases include:
 - 1. Firearms, weapons, or ammunition (or a resemblance of) unless related to the student organization mission.
 - 2. Tobacco or tobacco related products.
 - 3. Illegal or illicit substances or devices.
 - 4. Controlled substances.
 - 5. Vehicles, golf carts, vehicle trailers, or similar items that require a vehicle license or insurance. The application must thoroughly explain how the vehicle does not require a license or insurance.
- p. Any court actions.
- q. Costs or litigation against Purdue University, of its employees in fulfillment of their duties, or against its students.

C. General Prioritization (Scale 1= most frequently funded, 4= least frequently funded)

- 1. Events open to campus
 - a. ON campus, free of charge
 - b. ON campus, with minimal charge
 - c. OFF campus, free of charge
 - d. OFF campus, with minimal charge

2. Events not open to campus that are professional development, direct business of the college or organization, and/or educational, still in Tippecanoe County or Marion County
3. Travel outside of Tippecanoe County or Marion County for professional development, national conferences, direct business of the college or organization, and/or educational purposes
4. Equipment or supplies relating directly to the organizational purpose with no event

VII. APPLYING FOR SOGA FUNDS

A. General Application Guidelines

1. Each RSO is limited to one application per funding period (there are 4 funding periods).
2. All applications must be completed and submitted by the SOGA deadline. Submitted applications are reviewed as they stand at the deadline and cannot be modified.
3. Organizations cannot mutually apply for a SOGA Grant (Co-Sponsor) or combine multiple SOGA Grants for one event.
4. If an organization received an SFAB Grant for the current funding year, they are not eligible for SOGA.
5. Initiatives cannot have both SOGA and SFAB funding applied. (i.e. Organizations cannot collaborate to combine SOGA and SFAB funds for an event)
6. If a line item is misclassified, the line item will not be funded (i.e. Decorations put into Food/Beverage category).
7. Additional line items and fund requests cannot be added to an application after the submission deadline.
8. Application prioritization category can be adjusted by the board when reviewing the application as the board feels appropriate.
9. Applications falling into multiple prioritization categories should apply for the lower prioritization.
10. Applications falling under category 1 (a-d) must advertise their event to the wider University and ensure students outside their RSO are able to attend.
11. Allocated funds may be moved between approved line items at the discretion of the organization.
12. When classifying line items, supplies are items that are consumable or for short term use, while equipment is a more permanent, long-term asset.
13. It is highly recommended to include a description for each line item. Line items without ample description may not be funded.
14. Line items totals should include taxes and shipping fees when applicable. It is not necessary to have a separate line item for taxes and shipping fees.

B. Deadlines

1. Only one application may be submitted per organization per SOGA application funding period, and only one application will be approved per funding period per RSO. Submitting two or more applications in one period submitted at the submission deadline will lead to both becoming ineligible for funding and be automatically denied.
2. Application deadlines are posted on the Student Organization Grant Allocation (SOGA) page on the BoilerLink website. (www.BoilerLink.purdue.edu).
3. Any application submitted past the deadline for the current grant period will be rejected.

VIII. SPECIFIC GUIDELINES AND RESTRICTION BY EXPENDITURE TYPE

A. Honoraria and Payment for Professional Services Expenditures

1. Honoraria and Professional Services Guidelines:

- a. All payments to individuals or groups for professional services must be paid directly by BOSO to the individual or vendor performing the service. This includes, but is not limited to, speakers, lecturers, musicians, comics, hypnotists, theater performers, referees, and coaches. SOGA will not approve funding to an RSO to reimburse member(s) of an RSO for payment of an honoraria or professional service as listed below (2).
- b. Before payment will be made to the individual or vendor, the RSO needs to submit information to BOSO for completion of the contract. BOSO must review and sign all contracts.
- c. Consult with BOSO in advance for payment of contracted individuals who are not U.S. citizens. This must be done at least 90 days in advance.
- d. It is recommended that honoraria line-items be all-inclusive, with lodging, dining, and travel fees listed within a single line-item.

2. Honoraria and Professional Services Restrictions: (SOGA WILL NOT FUND)

- a. Payments to a member or members of a campus organization or RSO for services rendered to their own organization or RSO are prohibited.
- b. Retroactive salary payments for services or salaries of non-University personnel.
- c. Honoraria to Purdue University faculty or staff members.
- d. Honoraria to Purdue University students in the same organization

B. Communications Expenditures

1. Communications Guidelines:

- a. All advertising, marketing, and promotions funded and/or for events or activities funded (or partially funded) by SOGA must include the text: **“FUNDED BY SOGA”**
- b. Marketing and advertising expenses, include but are not limited to posters, banners, and online advertising. Promotional item expenses include but are not limited to tangible objects that are branded for the event. Marketing and promotional items collectively are capped at \$500 for the event, **including** only \$100 for flyers.
- c. SOGA will fund promotional items for the **event’s** promotion and advertising. These promotional items may include the organizations name, logo, and likeness as long as the event being funded is the most prominent (largest) on the promotional item. This does not apply to applications falling under Equipment prioritization.

2. **Communications Restrictions: (SOGA WILL NOT FUND)**

- a. Communications designed to honor, thank or congratulate an individual or group.
- b. Communications designed to publicize a fundraising event or to raise funds directly.
- c. Costs for design work for marketing, logos, letterhead, program covers, etc.
- d. Postage (unless publications are paramount to RSO's mission).
- e. SOGA will fund only normal display ads (not personal ads or classified ads).
- f. SOGA will not fund T-Shirts/sweatshirts/clothing for advertising and/or as promotional items.
- g. SOGA will not fund promotional items to be given out for organization advertising.
- h. SOGA will not fund the purchase of software, software subscriptions, or website hosting mechanisms that extend after the awarded period unless the approved application is in the Equipment prioritization category.

C. **Equipment Expenditures**

1. **Equipment Guidelines:**

- a. Please see SAO or BOSO in advance of ordering any permanent equipment.
- b. Individual equipment items over \$1000 funded by SOGA are considered to be University property. Such items will be inventoried annually with the University and may not be disposed of without the approval of BOSO.
- c. SOGA will not fund Office Supplies (paper, staplers, pens, toner, etc.) as a general operating expense for an RSO.
- d. Equipment purchased for an event must contain an ample description of how it will be utilized at the event.

2. **Equipment Restrictions: (SOGA WILL NOT FUND)**

- a. Equipment purchases for housing units or capital improvements.
- b. Equipment for resale for fundraisers or other purposes.
- c. Firearms, weapons, and ammunitions (or a resemblance of) unless related to the student organization mission.
- d. Equipment designed specifically for use with alcoholic beverages, drugs, or illegal substances.
- e. Furniture unless the use extends beyond standard furnishing purposes. This must be detailed in the application.
- f. Gaming equipment or related items intended for use in games of chance (for more information on this, please contact BOSO).
- g. Storage facility units unless in the Equipment prioritization category.

D. **Travel Expenditures**

1. **Travel Guidelines:**

- a. SOGA may fund travel expenses including, but not limited to, transportation, lodging, conference registration fees and competition entrance fees for members of an RSO to attend events including, but not limited to, conferences, conventions, and competitions which directly pertain to the purpose and goals of their RSO.
- b. SOGA may fund travel expenses for individuals who travel to the University to speak or perform for an RSO.

- c. All travel expenses must comply with allowances and restrictions established by University policy and regulations.
 - d. Procedures for payment and reimbursement of travel must be in accordance with the BOSO Manual section, "Dispersing Funds, Payment For Travel Expense", which can be accessed at <https://www.purdue.edu/business/boso/manual/travelExpenses.php>
- 2. Transportation – SOGA will generally fund the following:**
- a. Private automobile (mileage per University rate). SOGA only funds mileage to and from the event- no excess mileage will be funded. Drivers must be RMO1 Approved to receive reimbursement.
 - b. Rental vehicles
 - c. Chartered buses
 - d. Airfare and associated costs, such as luggage fees
- 3. Travel Restrictions: (SOGA WILL NOT FUND)**
- a. Meals included in travel either to or from the University
 - b. League or association dues, even if required to attend a conference or competition.
 - c. Travel costs for an individual or RSO engaged in lobbying, class work requirements, or job searching.
 - d. Rental vehicle insurance.
 - e. Telephone, internet, email, or cable charges.
 - f. Incidental travel not on original application.

IX. ALLOCATION PROCESS

- A. It is the responsibility of the RSO to clearly and thoroughly explain the request on the application. It is also the responsibility of RSO submitter to respond to any emails from the SOGA Board in a timely manner.
- B. The SOGA Board will review and discuss each application and decide specific funding allocations.
- C. The SOGA Board's decision may be in the form of one of the following:
 - 1. Fund the entire amount of the request
 - 2. Deny the entire request
 - 3. Fund a reduced amount of the request
- D. The SOGA Board will notify RSOs of their funding status via Boilerlink budget system to the RSO's submitter or treasurer with a copy given to the Business Office for Student Organizations.
- E. The RSO officers will meet with a SOGA representative to review expectations and sign a grant agreement form.
- F. RSOs cannot be inactive, frozen, or otherwise ineligible to receive funding at the time of signing the grant agreement form.

X. REQUEST FOR MODIFICATION

- A. If the request needs to be modified or changed after being accepted, the RSO must submit a Request for Modification form found on Boilerlink as long as the purpose of the event does not change.

- B. The RSO does not need to submit a Request for Modification if it is for a change of date within the period that funding was awarded, or a change in location as long as the location change does not affect the category that funding was awarded in (e.g. it changing from one on campus building to another does not need approval but changing from on campus to off campus does).
- C. The RSO can move up their event's prioritization category without a Request for Modification (Moving from 1C to 1A). A Request for Modification needs to be submitted to move down in prioritization category (e.g. moving from 1A to 1C).
- D. Due to the limited timeframe of each period, modification requests may only be submitted up to 30 days into a funding period and will be reviewed at that time.
- E. Line items cannot be added through modification. Line items can be changed or altered in extenuating circumstances at the discretion of the board.
- F. No additional funds can be awarded through Request for Modification.

NOTE: Date changes outside the awarded funding period will not be accepted.

XI. PROCESSING EXPENDITURES FOR APPROVED EVENTS

A. General

- 1. All financial contracts and expenditures will be processed by the BOSO per University Policy.
- 2. All SOGA funds will be revoked if the event does not take place.
- 3. Expenditures that total over \$1000 may be paid directly by BOSO to the vendor.
- 4. The RSO will only receive funds to cover the exact expenditures up to the amount approved or less.

B. Obtaining SOGA Money After Approval of Application

- 1. BOSO will receive written notification from the SOGA Board Chairperson before the start of the period.
- 2. After the grant approval is received, RSO must meet with a SOGA representative within 2 weeks. The person who submitted the original grant application will be the one contacted for this meeting. If a different person should be contacted for the grant meeting, it is the duty of the organization to notify SOGA@Purdue.edu as soon as possible.
- 3. The funds will be deposited into the RSO's account after meeting with the SOGA Specialist or other SOGA representative to review the SOGA Budget and Activity Form. Failure to meet with the SOGA Specialist within two weeks of grant approval will result in forfeiture of SOGA funding. If expenditures have occurred, funds will be transferred from the RSO's General Account to reimburse SOGA.
- 4. SOGA funds are not made available until the start of the funding period, including being accessible for immediate reimbursement. Organizations should not make any purchases prior to the start of a period assuming they will be reimbursed. An organization may request that spending may begin before the funding period by submitting an Early Expenditure Request form from the SOGA page. Request must demonstrate a clear need for early expenditure.

C. Documentation Requirements for Funding Transfer and Reimbursements

1. A completed SOGA Final Report must be turned in no later than 30 days after the end of the funding period. A Final Report must be submitted even if the event does not take place. The SOGA Final Report will be available on BoilerLink.
2. Reimbursements to individuals and direct invoice payments may be processed by the RSO through BOSO upon approval of the initial SOGA funding application and approval by SAO and BOSO through an Activity Planning Form.
3. All expenditures and reimbursements must be submitted to BOSO within 30 days after the end of the funding period. Expenditures submitted more than 30 days after the end of the funding period will generally not be paid by SOGA.
4. RSOs that do not submit the SOGA Final Report within 30 days after the end of the funding period generally will not be funded for their expenditures per the discretion of the SOGA Board and will lose SOGA funding for a year.
5. Be cautious before incurring expenses through an E-Business (online business). Often, E-Businesses do not provide RSOs with adequate documentation of a purchase and secondary documentation will be required. RSOs need to check with the business and BOSO before ordering about the type of receipt/invoice they will be receiving.
6. The SOGA Board may at any time request back up documentation on an expense supported by SOGA funds. Typically, the RSO treasurer will be contacted by e-mail. It is the treasurer's responsibility to respond to any questions BOSO or the SOGA Board may have about an expenditure request in a timely manner.
7. It is the responsibility of the RSO to understand the reimbursement process and BOSO procedures. The SOGA board is not responsible for ensuring payments and reimbursement are submitted appropriately.
8. Contact the SOGA Board (soga@purdue.edu) for guidance in advance if there are any questions about documentation requirements.

XII. CONTACT INFORMATION

- ❖ If assistance is needed, please contact Student Activities and Organizations.
 - Office: SAO / Krach Leadership Center, Room 370
 - Phone: (765) 494-1231
 - Email soga@purdue.edu or SAO@purdue.edu